

Interview decisions and wording review

10 October 2026 | v0.4 Review 7 | Candidate for Dan's final approval

What the interview settled

Dan Sonsie is the founder of Carpenters for Housing Reform Victoria, with approximately 20 years of practical carpentry experience. Informal industry discussions inform the submission; no formal endorsement or mandate to represent every Victorian carpenter is claimed. No incorporated or statutory institute status is asserted.

Constructive support

Support baseline residential carpenter registration in principle, with government still needing to justify scope, costs, assessment and transition arrangements. Meeting impressions of uncertainty remain practitioner observations, not a departmental decision.

RRC pilot and leadership

Propose Registered Residential Carpenter as a candidate for a bounded pilot of additional residential capability. Dan offers a lead role with a government-supported team; government determines appointments and resources. Independent evaluation must permit the pathway to change, narrow or discontinue. No appointment, funding allocation or statutory authority is claimed.

Core positions retained

Residential baseline; common technical competence with separate relevant role requirements; apprenticeship plus Certificate III normally establishes future-entrant competence; verified existing-worker equivalence and targeted gap training. Independent business requirements and additional assessed capability remain separate from the baseline. Existing builder pathways and specialist boundaries remain.

Work remains practical

Routine low-value work should have proportionate administration within applicable law. Rot alone does not automatically trigger specialist referral. A specific unresolved safety, design, approval or authority boundary does. No new \$30,000-\$50,000 cap, compulsory extra examination or automatic project entitlement is adopted.

Where to find the changes

Author and evidence attribution: page 1. RRC pilot in the executive position: page 2. Questions 4, 6 and 7: pages 4-7. Interstate comparison: page 9. Pilot and leadership offer: page 10. Conclusion: pages 14-15.

Source checks and next steps

These findings support the wording; they are not legal sign-off or proof of pilot effectiveness.

Interstate comparisons

NSW has carpentry contractor licences and separate qualified-supervisor certificates for defined work; its published scope excludes whole garages, sheds and carports. Queensland has a carpentry licence class and contractor-type licences allowing direct contracts within licensed scope, with business and financial requirements. Neither scheme automatically transfers its permissions to Victoria.

Outcome data

QBCC publishes 2024-25 defect-topic counts, including timber door/window installation. NSW publishes regional targeted-inspection findings. These are useful starting points but do not isolate the causal effect of carpenter licensing or establish a before/after pilot result. A full comparative evaluation remains to be done; no positive outcome is inferred.

Funding

The Victorian Budget 2026/27 confirms \$16 million for implementing registration and licensing requirements. That is not an allocation to Dan or an RRC pilot, and does not establish a final carpenter-scheme design.

Verification completed

Full Review 6 paragraph and table wording reviewed against the approved directions; the Review 7 changes are recorded exactly. All 17 Review 7 pages rendered and visually inspected. All 13 question headings, five tables and four unchanged policy/evidence tables retained; v0.3 hashes unchanged. Contrary evidence, historical financial figures and original source classifications retained.

Remaining limits

Final scheme rules, corporate/mixed-use boundaries, qualification coverage and transition mapping, financial-limit rationale and carpenter-specific insurance remain unresolved. Final contract-reform making and live submission-form requirements were not verified. Independent legal, policy, economic and practitioner reviews have not been completed. These limits remain explicit; the pilot is a recommendation, not an operating scheme.

Next action

Review and approve the exact Review 7 PDF for government submission. Use Review 7 as the current candidate; retain Review 6 as history. The transfer ZIP contains the Word/PDF pair, decision and QC records, historical checkpoints and one updated GitHub prompt. No public branch import, merge or government submission has been performed. Each requires the applicable explicit approval. GitHub merging is separate from timely government lodgement.